DIGITAL ARCHEOLOGY

Mini Project

BY: SARAH GADDIS

S O U R C E S

(Project Gutenberg)

"Apicii librorum X qui dicuntur De re coquinaria quae extant" by Apicius

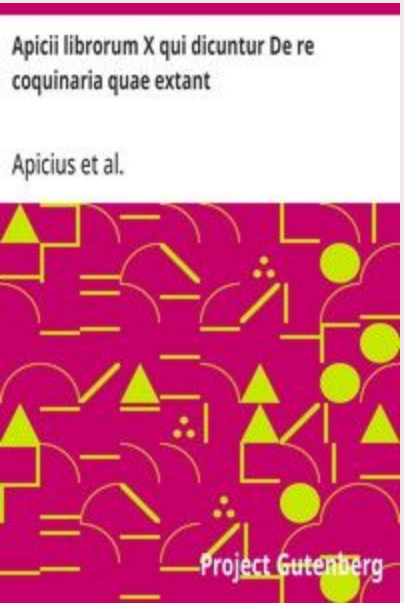
"Cookery and Dining in Imperial Rome" by Apicius

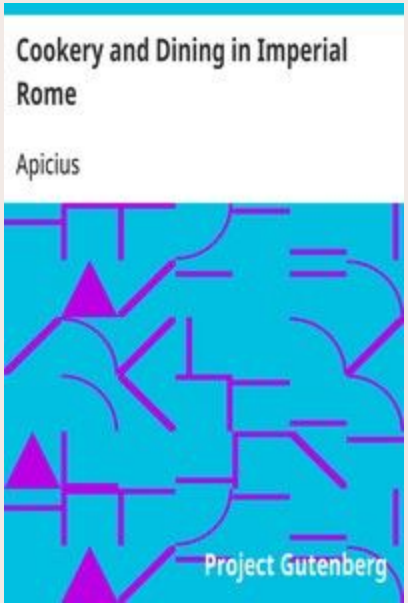
"A guide to modern cookery" by A. Escoffier

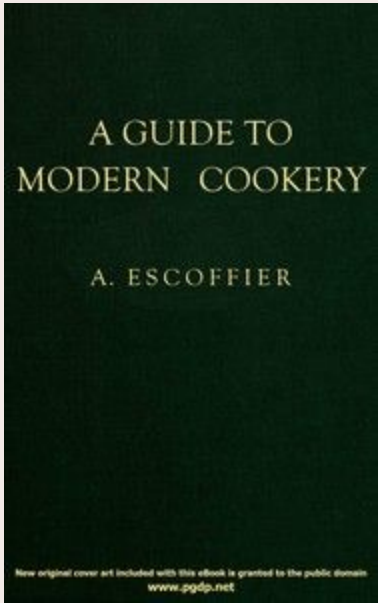
QUESTIONS

How does english vs latin versions of a cookbook differ in word frequency of the most popular ingredients?

How do the top foods in ancient Rome differ from the top foods in 1900s America, based on cookbooks?







APPROACH

1. Get word counts from Python code
2. Review results and get totals of top foods*
3. Organize and plot results
4. Retrieve matching words from latin version

PROBLEMS

- Duplicates of words due to symbols & caps
- Generic words like “sauce”, “soup”, etc
- Latin translations can be complicated

Cookery and Dining in Imperial Rome

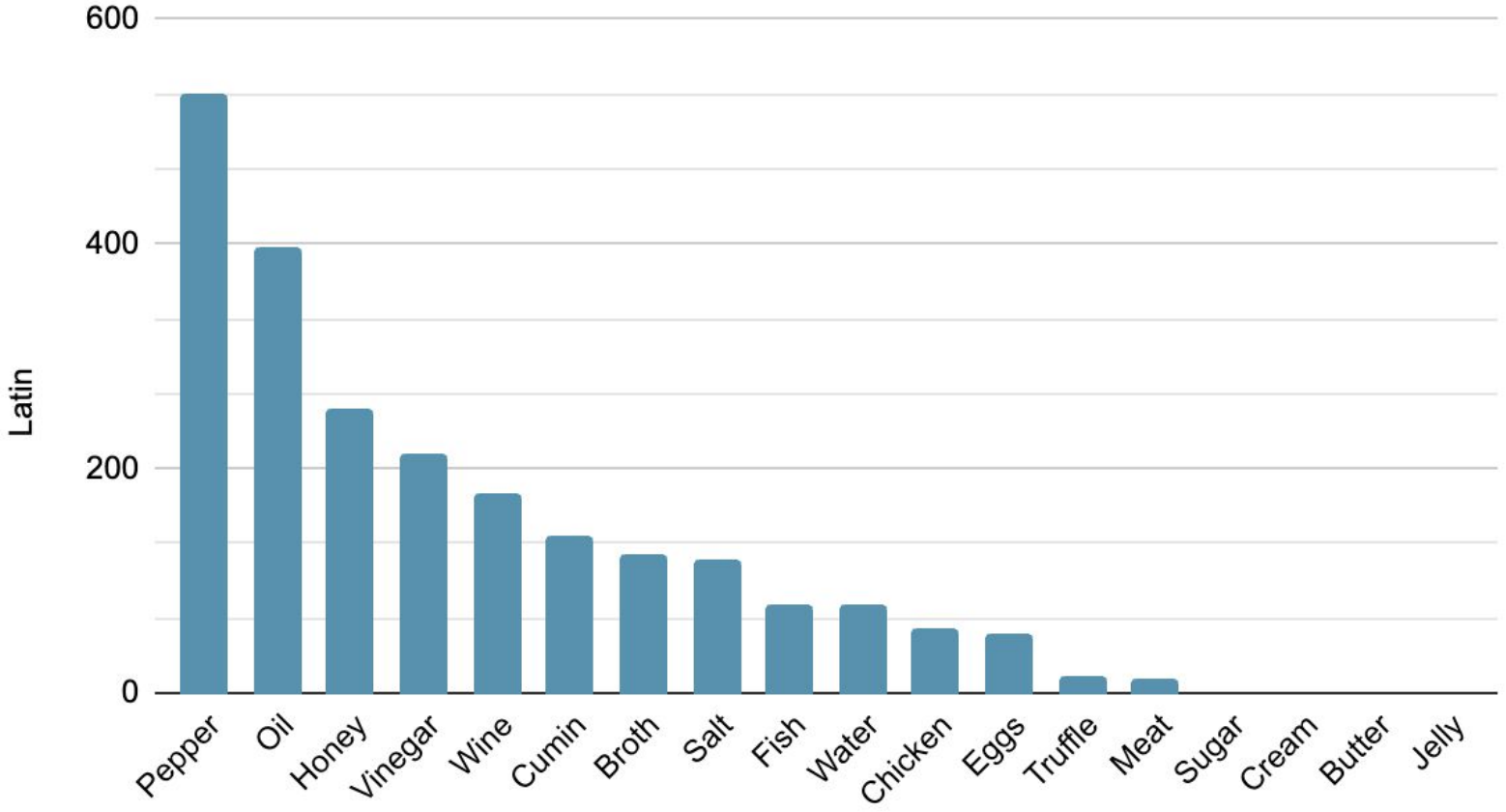
1. Pepper
2. Broth
3. Wine
4. Oil
5. Fish
6. Honey
7. Vinegar
8. Meat
9. Cumin
10. Salt

RESULTS

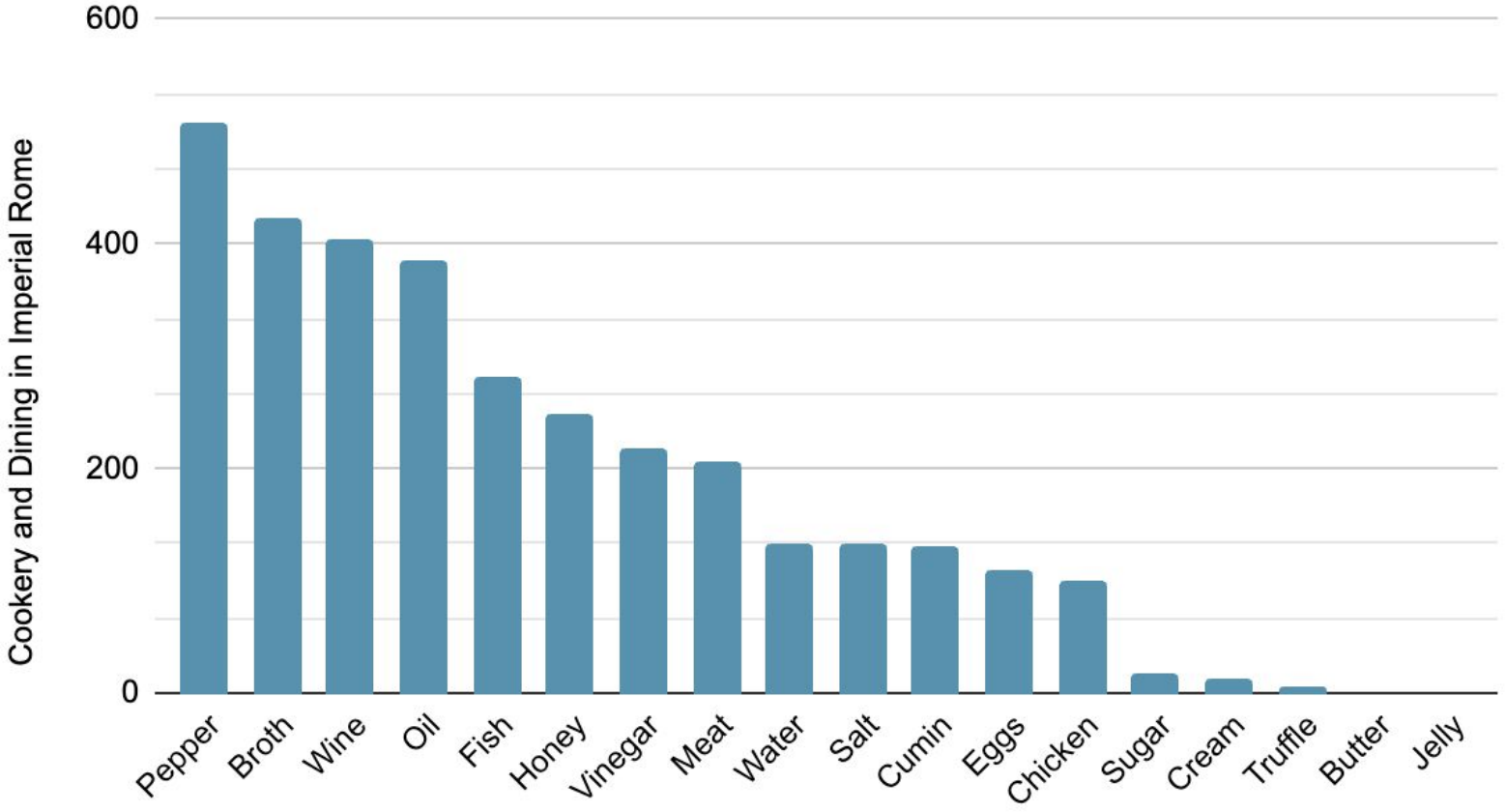
A Guide to Modern Cookery

1. Butter
2. Meat
3. Truffle
4. Cream
5. Eggs
6. Fish
7. Water
8. Jelly
9. Sugar
10. Chicken

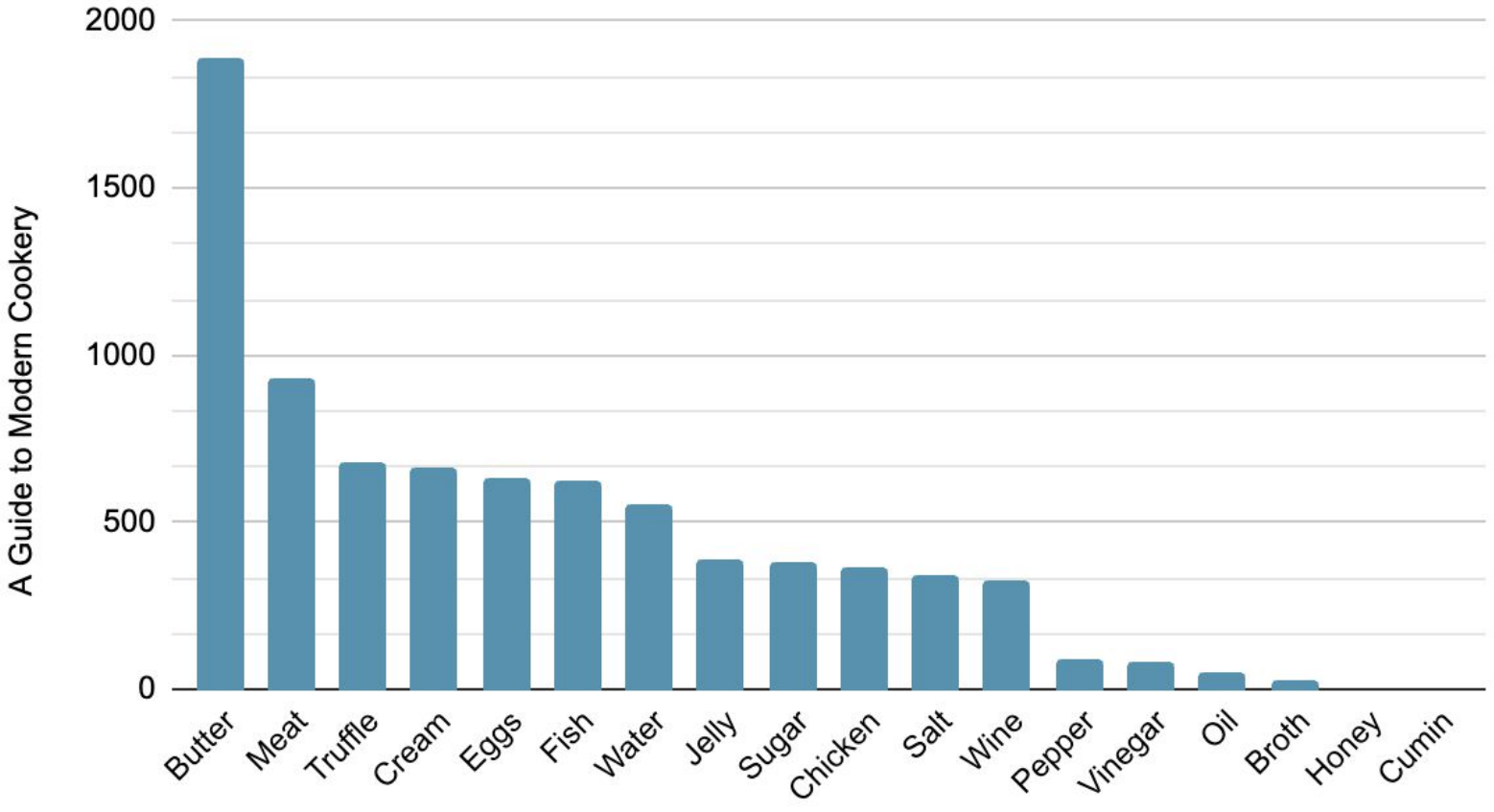
Latin Version



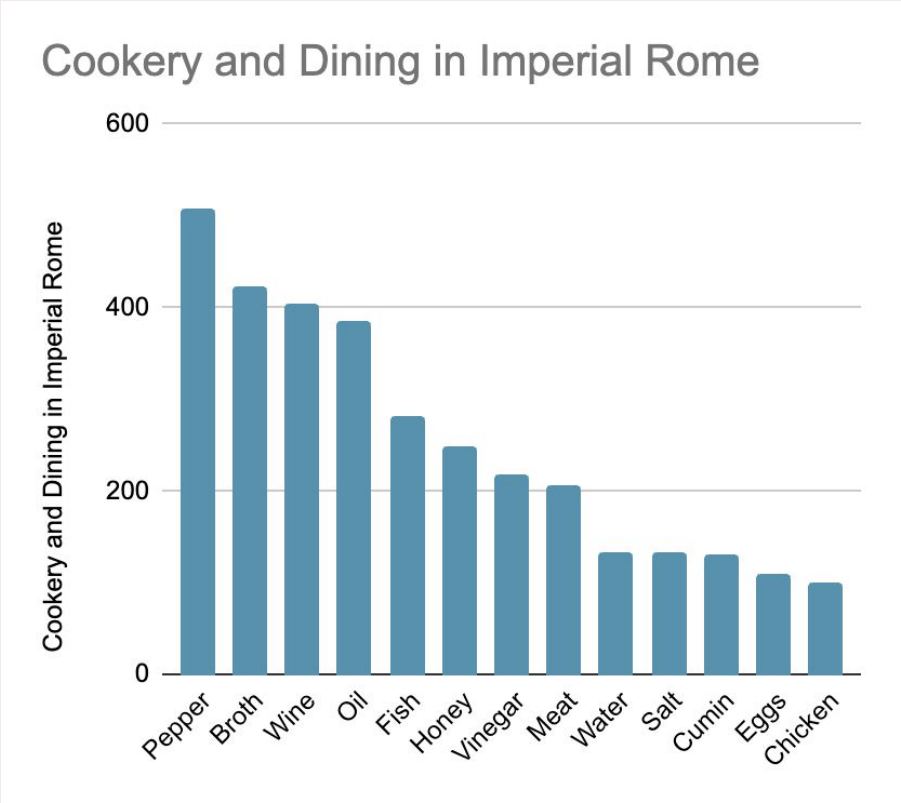
Cookery and Dining in Imperial Rome

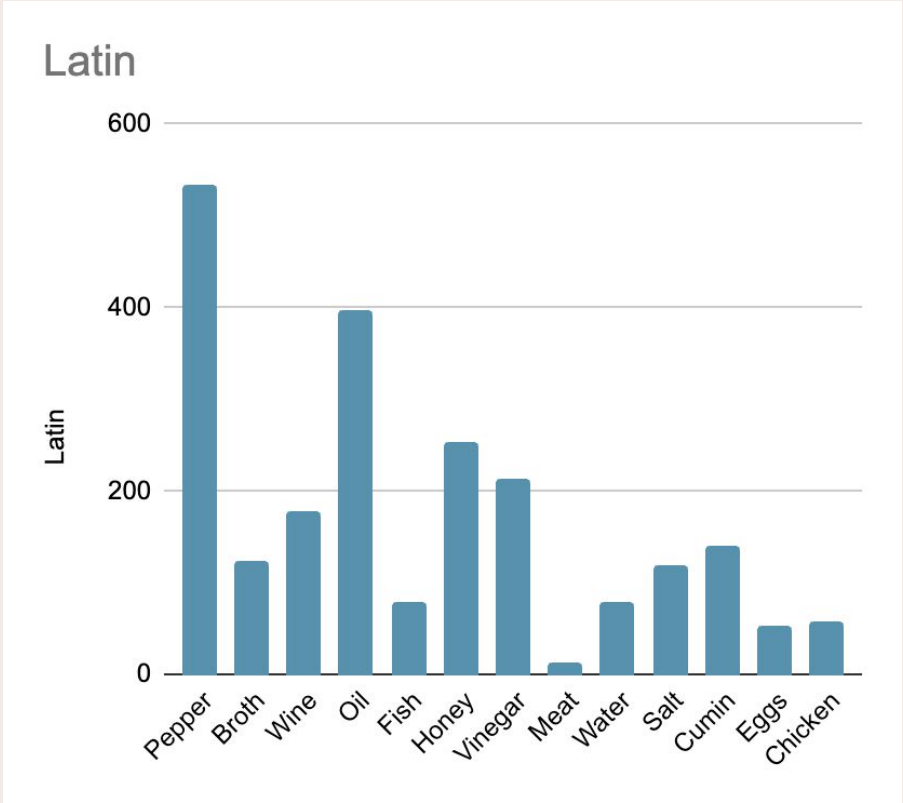


A Guide to Modern Cookery

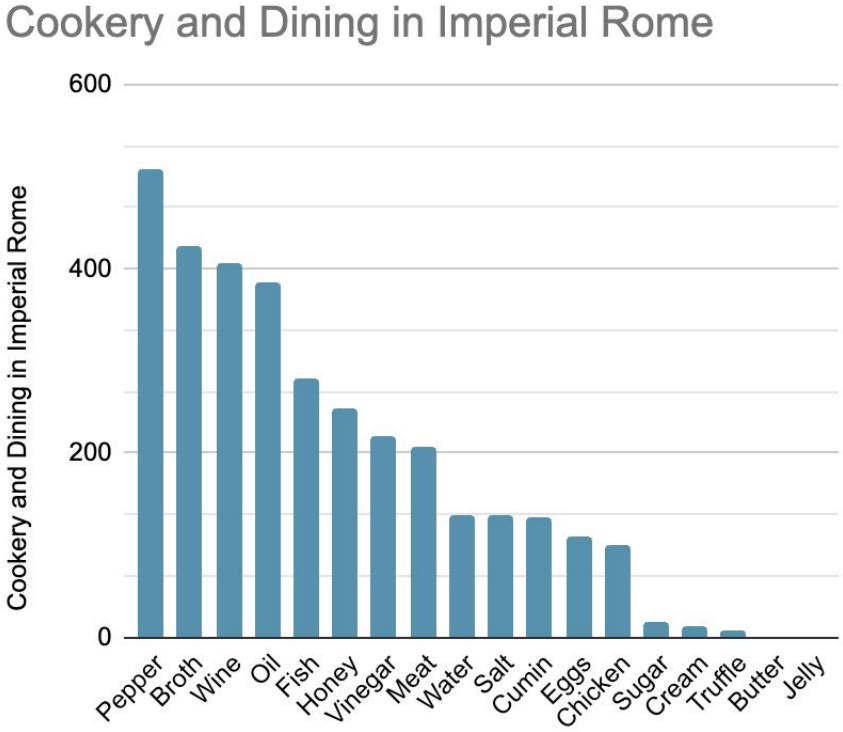


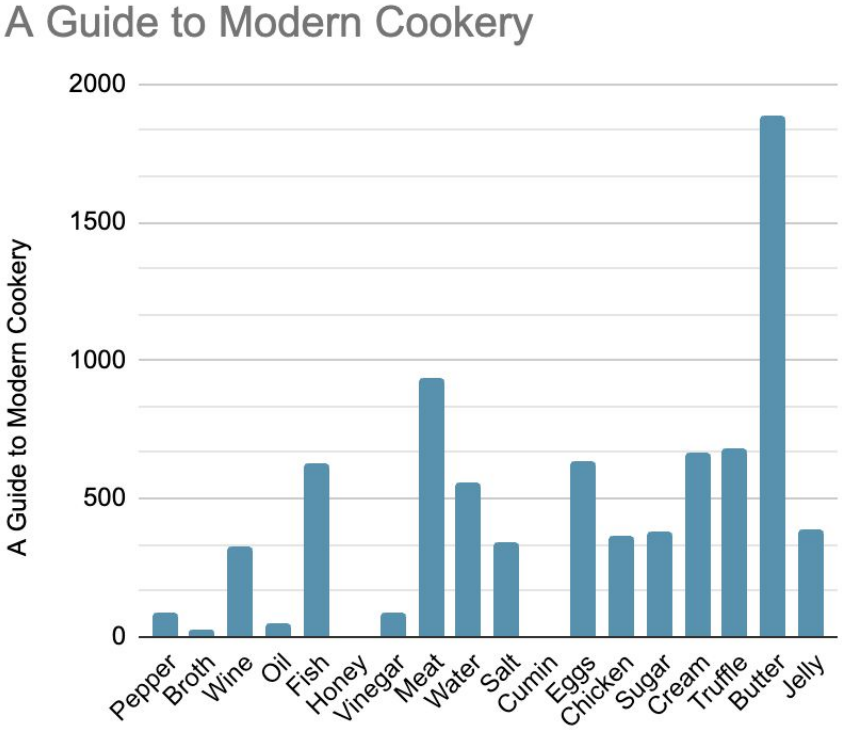
English vs Latin Ingredients





Imperial Rome vs Modern Cookery





NOTES

- 1900s cooking uses much more dairy & sugar than Ancient Rome, specifically butter, cream, jelly, etc
- Fruits, veggies, and grains are present in both times, just with much lower word counts
- Modern cookery "truffles" are "edible fungi that grow underground on/near tree roots", not chocolates!
- I don't speak latin, I did my best to translate

NEW IDEAS

- Which ingredients have increased in popularity?
- Which ingredients have stood the test of time?
- How did food access and culture influence each of these cookbooks?

The End!